

Colorado Field Ornithologists Sight Record Form

(This is a two-page report. Please print or type. Attach photographs and additional pages if necessary.)

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RESULTS:

Species:(Common Name): **Acorn Woodpecker**(Scientific Name): *Melanerpes formicivorus*Date(s) of occurrence: **20 May 2000**Number of birds seen: **1**Sex: **Unknown** (see description below)Plumage: **Adult**Exact location: **Mace Trail / Tower Trail loop - Pueblo Mountain Park (south-west of Devils Canyon).**County: **Pueblo**Nearest town: **Beulah**Elevation: **about 7000 feet**Length of observation: **About 2 minutes.**Time(s) of observation: **10:40am**Other observers who saw the bird(s) with you: **Dave Van Manen, Kermit Heck and Marilyn Rolan**Other Observers who independently saw the bird(s): **0**Light Conditions (quality; direction relative to bird(s); position: **Slightly overcast - excellent conditions.**Optical equipment used: **7x50 Binoculars**Distance from bird(s) (estimated unless otherwise noted): **100-150 yards.**Was bird(s) photographed? **No**If so, have you submitted photos? **NA**Who took the photographs? **NA**Describe the general and specific habitat in which the bird(s) occurred: **The bird was located in mostly oak with coniferous forest (foothills). The bird was perched at the top of one of the many large dead conifer trees in the area.**Describe the bird's behavior (flying, feeding, habits, behaviors used in identifying the Species or in supporting the identification): **The bird just sat there for a minute or so then flew off in a "buoyant" manner similar to the flight of other woodpeckers.**

Describe the bird in detail. This is the most important part of this report. Include the overall size and shape and how you placed the bird in the general group that you did. Give complete details of plumage, including head, throat, undersides, nape, back, wings and tail. Give particular emphasis to marks you used to identify the bird(s). Describe other important details, such as color and shape of bill, legs, eye, (etc.) that were important in making the identification. (Fill out this portion even if photographs are submitted; you may attach additional sheets, drawings, field sketches or copy field notes):

The bird was first seen perched in a tree and appeared to be a bit smaller than a Lewis' Woodpecker. At first glance only the dorsal side was observable. The red crown immediately caught my attention, then the bird turned its head allowing for a decent view of the creamy-white colored forehead and throat. The birds pale eye also was conspicuous against the black color of the rest of the face. The bird had a longer black bill (bordered by black feathers) suggestive of a woodpecker, a black "mantle" and a black tail. The folded wings were covering the rump somewhat and little attention was focused to this area but the birds black tail was noticed. The bird did allow a glimpse of the whitish flanks but the breast was not observed. The bird was briefly seen as it flew off and the white primary bases formed a conspicuous white wing patch. The white belly and rump were observable in flight. [Please see attached drawing of bird and extended wing].

Describe bird's call or song: **No vocalizations were heard.**Discuss similar species and how you eliminated them: **From behind the birds shape and posture suggested a Lewis' Woodpecker but the red cap quickly ruled that species out. After observing the bird's off-white facial markings plus the pale eye against the black background ruled out White-headed Woodpecker. The solid black coloration on the head, nape and cheek areas, along with the red crown, ruled out all other possible species.**What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species? **I have never seen this species myself, although I have seen many photographs, drawings, and videos (television programs) of this species. I am familiar with this species from reading field guides in preparation for a previous search near Lake Dorothy SWA, CO last summer. I am familiar with the other woodpeckers in Colorado from previous experiences birding and studying some literature.**List books, guides, recordings or other sources consulted and how this influenced your identification (during and after observation): **Having been familiar with identifying this species prior to this observation, I was certain of the identification before consulting any other resources. Identification was confirmed using National Geographic's Field Guide to the Birds of North America and the Audubon Field Guide to the Birds of North America, Western Region.**This report is from notes made during or after observation or later from memory: **Later from some notes, but mostly from memory.**Date of written report: **20 May 2000**Reporting observer: **Paul Joseph Hurtado**Signature: *Paul J. Hurtado* 5-2-00Reporting Observer's Address: **107 Carlile Ave.**City: **Pueblo**State: **Colorado**Zip: **81004-1014**



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